

Red Peppers

By Gus Schrader

Don't Curse 'Em

EARL WEAVER, Baltimore Orioles manager, says he's being ejected from games less and enjoying it more.

A bunch of writers were chinning with the tough little skipper in the dugout prior to last Monday's playoff finale with the Minnesota Twins. The subject of umpires came up, as it often does. Someone asked Earl if he will be more restrained in his dealings with the umpires, as it would be highly embarrassing to be ejected from a playoff or World Series game.

"No, I won't be any more restrained," Weaver replied. "The games may be more important, but then your argument becomes more important, too."

Weaver proved his point in the first inning of that game. He came out to demand the umpires chase a man who was suspiciously watching the game from an empty panel on the Twins scoreboard in center field.

"Probably he wasn't doing anything unusual," Weaver explained after the game, "but we watched him through the binoculars and wondered if he could be spying on our catcher's signals and tipping them off to the Twins. It looked as if his hands went up when our catcher called for a breaking pitch."

Usually Weaver's run-ins with umpires are more fiery than this one. Oddly enough, three of the four times he was banished this season were in the Minnesota park.

"I don't curse umpires any more," Weaver was saying. "In fact, I haven't cursed an umpire since 1954. Oh, I beg your pardon. I did curse one since then—just once—and I was kicked out for it."

Don't Get Personal

"What happened back in 1954 that caused me to change? Well, I was playing for Denver. My manager was Andy Cohen, a great guy. After I had cursed out an umpire and got thrown out of a game, he came over and gently asked me if I felt good about it."

"I said, 'No, I feel lousy. I'm ashamed of myself.' Andy pointed out something that made a deep impression on me. He said the umpire can't fight back when you curse him out there. You're picking on a defenseless man."

Baseball men will tell you, of course, you can get away with moderate profanity in talking to an umpire, but you're likely to get the old heave-ho if you direct it at him personally.

For instance, you can say, "That was a blankety-blank call, because the blankety-blank runner was out by a blankety-blank

mile." But you CANNOT say, "You blind blankety-blank so-and-so, you blew that call."

"That's right," agreed Weaver, "but you can insult an umpire and humiliate him without using curse words. . . . I've found out most umpires will throw you out faster if you argue with them after they've booted a call than when they think they're right. They're sensitive then."

Weaver was asked: "Do you ever charge out to argue with an umpire even though you know you're wrong?"

"Never," he replied. "I don't believe in that. However, I have charged out there and found out I was wrong before I got back. One of our players may tell you the umpire was right, or maybe the umpire explains something you didn't see on the play."

"But I'm no phony; I don't go out there just to try to win the umpire's next decision."

Pass the Hash

● What kind of guy is Dave Krull, Iowa's baseball shortstop who came out for football this fall and has been a big help to the Hawkeyes at split end? Well, we don't know Dave



DAVE KRULL

well, having met him only once (after the Iowa-Arizona game), but we have evidence he's a humble, unspoiled athlete. George Kampling, The Gazette's sports correspondent in Iowa City, recently wrote a feature on Dave. Fortunately, we printed it before Dave hit the headlines with his three pass catches against Arizona. He suffered a cut arm in that game, went to the hospital at halftime to have 10 stitches taken and returned to action. Wow, did he return! He caught his third pass for a gain of 13 yards, then threw the most spectacular block Iowa has seen in a long time. He wiped out two Arizona defenders to let Denny Green scoot 70 yards for the clinching touchdown. Not a bad day for a kid who had never played in a college football game until this year.

Well, before the Arizona game, Dave sat down and wrote the following letter to Kampling: "Dear Mr. Kampling: I'd like to thank you for the article that appeared in The Gazette Sept. 18 entitled 'Shortstop to Split End.' I appreciate the time you put into it and I think you did an excellent job. I feel it a real honor to be selected for a feature article in your paper. Thank you again, and if there's anything I can do for you, please let me know, because I'll be more than happy to assist you in any way (signed) Dave Krull."

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● John Montpas, 2739 Dalewood avenue SE, found four Iowa-Wisconsin tickets in an envelope at Second avenue SE at Fourth street Thursday afternoon. He was hoping to find the owners before they left for Madison.